Caring for the Earth was prepared in 1991 by the International Union for the Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources (IUCN) and it identified nine principles of sustainable development. The priority requirements of Caring for the Earth are as follows:

- Respect and care for the community of life
- Improve the quality of human life
- Conserve the Earth's vitality and diversity
- Minimize the depletion of non-renewable resources
- Keep within the Earth's carrying capacity
- Change personal attitudes and practices
- Enable communities to care for their own environments
- Forge a global alliance.[7]

The publication of *Our Common Future*[*] and the work of the *World Commission on Environment and Development* laid the groundwork for the convening of the 1992 Earth Summit and the adoption of Agenda 21, the Rio Declaration, and also the establishment of the Commission on Sustainable Development.

The United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED also referred to as the *Rio Summit* or the *Earth Summit*) was held from 3 June to 14 June 1992. The chief achievement of this Summit was the **Agenda 21: Green Paths to the Future** or the **Rio Declaration of 1992***.* The Rio Declaration consisted of 27 principles intended to guide future sustainable development around the world. Some of the principles contained in the Rio Declaration may be regarded as the third generation rights.